FALCONS VALLEY · SPIŠSKÁ STARÁ VES وادي الصقور

A falconry centre below the Tatras. Breeding hall, flight aviaries and a lounge.

Concept study and visualisation of a falcon breeding centre at hall no. 98 (parcel 4930/15) in Spišská Stará Ves, Slovakia: a two-storey breeding hall, three flight aviaries of 2,400 – 2,700 m² each, a central glazed majlis-style lounge and wild hacking of young falcons in the Pieniny mountains.

53 × 60 m
breeding hall ≈ 3 200 m² per floor · 2 floors

3 × ≈ 2 500 m²
flight aviaries · nets 6 – 8 m · 7 290 m² in total

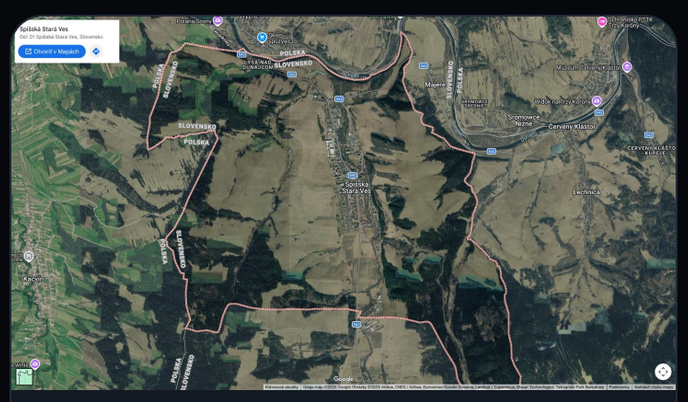
⌀ 22 m
central lounge · tinted glass into all three sections

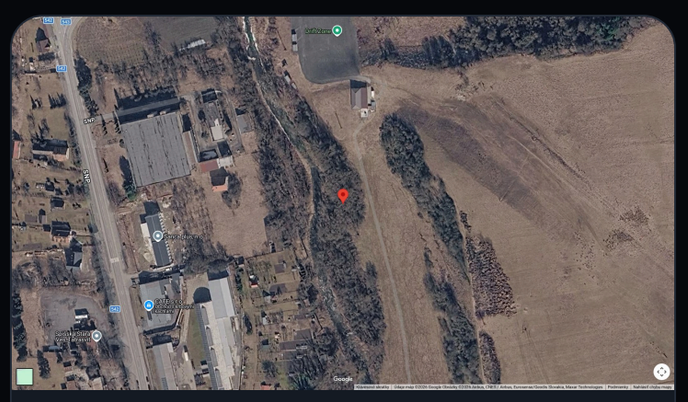
2 – 4 weeks
wild hacking of fledglings in the open

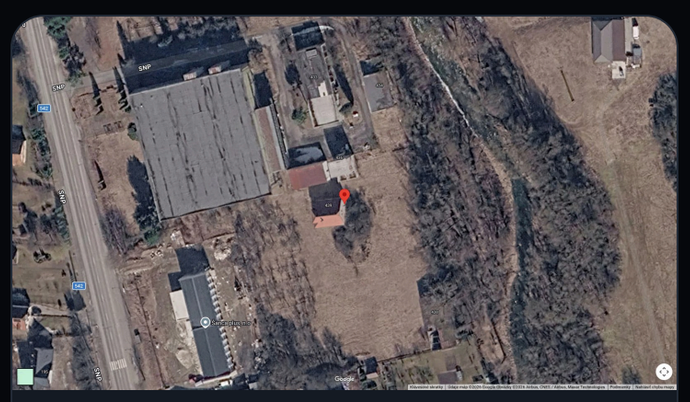
01 · LOCATION

Spišská Stará Ves, the site on SNP street

The site sits on the northern edge of the town between SNP street and the Rieka stream, about 1 km from the Dunajec river and the Polish border, within sight of the Pieniny mountains. The existing two-storey industrial hall (no. 98, parcel 4930/15) has a solid reinforced-concrete frame suitable for conversion into breeding chambers. The aviary plot is a flat meadow behind the hall with sides of 90 / 89 / 92 / 91 m (≈ 7 850 m² per the cadastre). The existing house no. 439 on the plot will be demolished to free the whole area for the aviaries.







Google Maps · wider area. Spišská Stará Ves on the Dunajec is the gateway to the Pieniny and Zamagurie. Poprad-Tatry airport ≈ 50 km, Kraków ≈ 110 km.

Google Maps · satellite. The hall on SNP street, behind it the meadow bounded by the tree line along the Rieka stream. Top right the “Drift Zone” area and fields towards the Dunajec.

Google Maps · plot detail. Building numbers 433, 434, 436 (hall yard), 439 (house on the plot, to be demolished) and 438 (shed in the south-east corner) match the cadastral map.

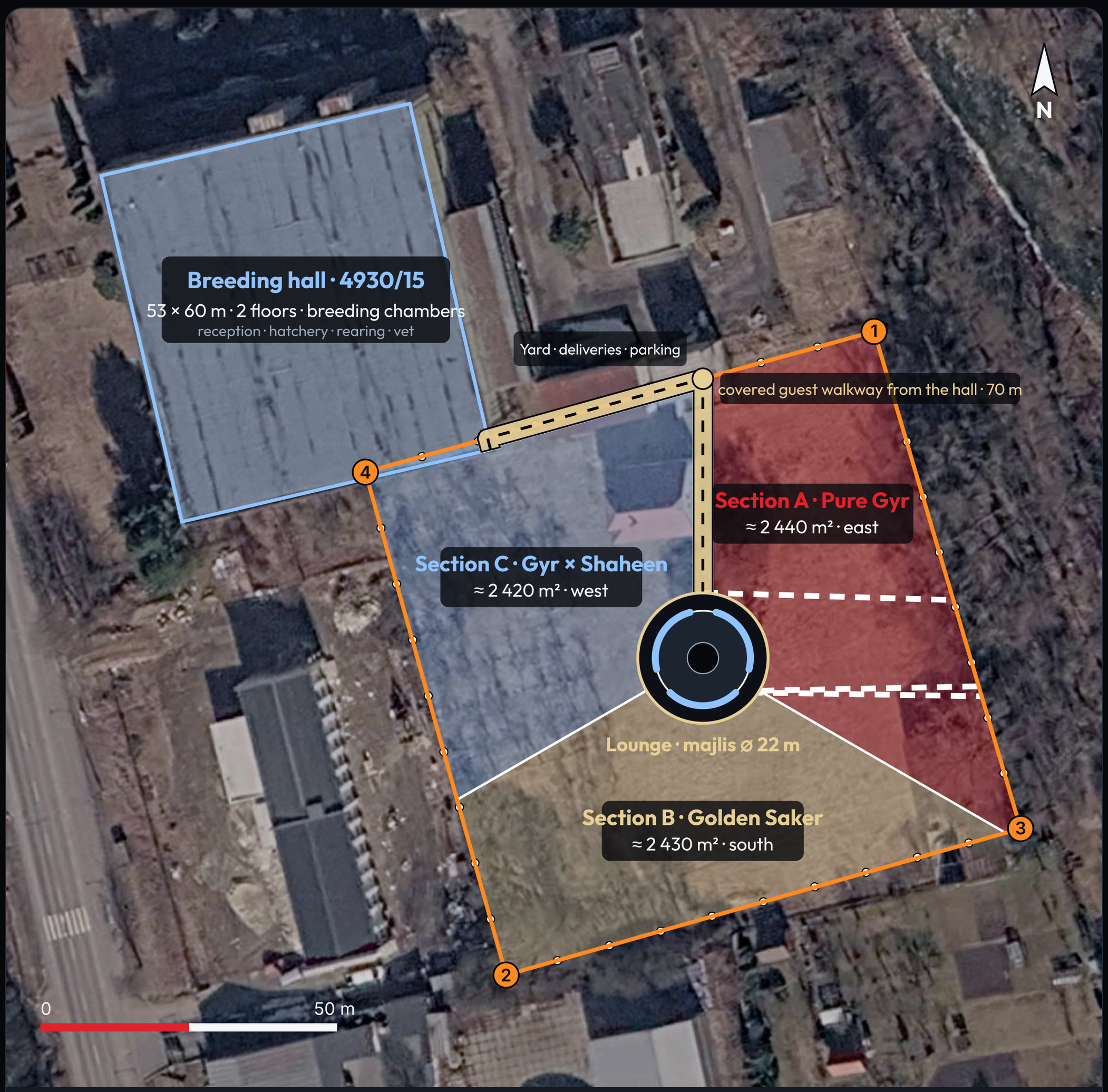


Your own photos of the site and surroundings (from your phone) will be added here – just send them and they go into the gallery.

03 · SITE PLAN

The hall, three flight sections and the lounge in the centre

The plot is divided from a single centre into three 120° sectors. Each section has its own entrance through a safety porch, its own shelter and bath. In the centre stands a circular lounge whose three glazed walls face the three aviaries – all three falcon lines can be watched from one spot. Guests arrive from the reception in the hall along a covered walkway (≈ 70 m) that runs along the northern boundary and then between sections A and C straight into the lounge.



Site plan on Google satellite imagery (north up). The orange line is the plot boundary from the cadastre (indicative; a surveyor will set out the exact corners). The hall outline is traced from the satellite image (53 × 60 m). White dots are net masts every ≈ 9 m, dashed lines the double net walls between sections, the yellow strip the covered guest walkway.

Breeding hall 4930/15 · Section A – pure Gyr · Section B – Golden Saker · Section C – Gyr × Shaheen · Lounge · majlis · Covered guest walkway · Plot boundary

OBJECT	AREA	FUNCTION	NOTE
Breeding hall (4930/15)	53 × 60 m · ≈ 3 200 m² / floor	reception, breeding chambers, hatchery, rearing, vet, storage	existing 2-storey hall, conversion

OBJECT	AREA	FUNCTION	NOTE
Section A – east	≈ 2 440 m²	flight aviary · pure Gyr	the shadiest side by the tree line – suits gyrs
Section B – south	≈ 2 430 m²	flight aviary · Golden Saker	the sunniest part of the plot
Section C – west	≈ 2 420 m²	flight aviary · Gyr × Shaheen	next to the hall yard – short route from the chambers
Lounge · majlis	⌀ 22 m · ≈ 200 m² interior + terrace	seating, tea, watching the falcons through tinted glass	circular pavilion in the centre of the plot
Covered walkway	≈ 70 m · 3 m	guest access from the hall reception to the lounge	along the north boundary and between sections A / C
Aviaries total	**≈ 7 290 m²**	each section above the required minimum of 2,000 m²	

Why a circle and three sectors? Dividing from one centre gives each section a similar area, the longest possible flight line (sector diagonal 55 – 70 m) and gives the lounge a view into all three aviaries without guests having to move. Falcons of different lines cannot see each other through the double net walls with a 1 m gap, so there is no stress and no attacks through the net.

04 · BREEDING HALL

Two floors: services below, breeding chambers above

The hall (53 × 60 m) will be converted into a closed breeding station with controlled access. The ground floor takes the guest reception and everything the hatchery and staff need; the whole upper floor is made up of skylit breeding chambers where the pairs nest undisturbed and without human contact.

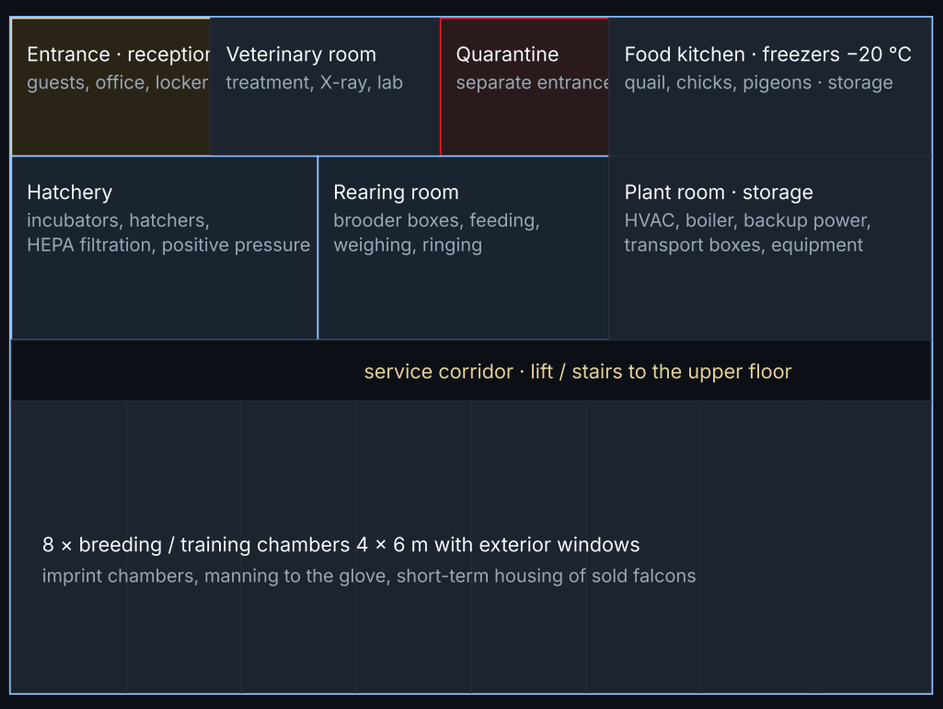


Interior concept. Central service corridor, two rows of chambers with timber slat walls, daylight from skylights, upper-floor gallery.

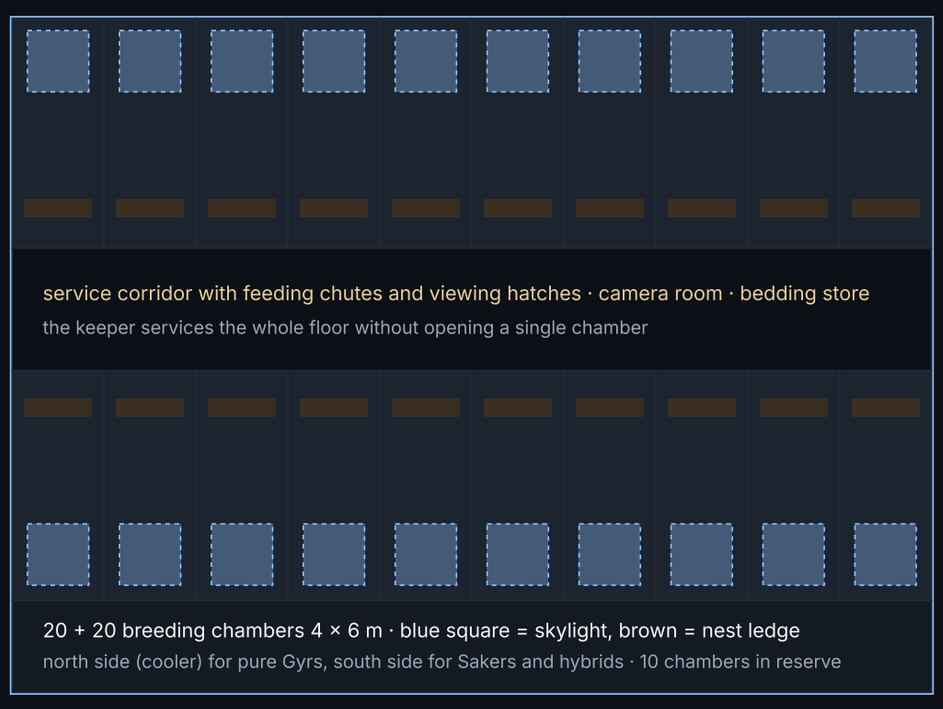
Breeding chamber – standard

- **4 × 6 m**, 3.5 m high, timber slat walls (no sharp edges)
- skylight / netted roof over 1/3 of the area – daylight and rain
- 1 × 1 m nest ledge with river gravel, 2 – 3 perches, bath
- feeding chute from the corridor – the pair never sees the keeper
- double doors (porch), one-way viewing hatch and IP camera in every chamber
- sloped washable floor with drain; draught-free ventilation
- for gyrs: the cooler north side of the hall, filtered dry ventilation (aspergillosis prevention)

Ground floor – reception, services and hatchery



Upper floor – skylit breeding chambers



Biosecurity

- one-way flow: entrance → changing room → disinfection → clean zone
- quarantine with its own entrance and ventilation

Climate and light

- unheated but draught-free chambers; shade and cool for gyrs
- natural photoperiod through the skylights drives the breeding cycle

Technology

- IP cameras with night vision in the chambers, 30-day recording
- backup power for the hatchery and freezers

- hatchery under positive pressure with HEPA filtration
- guests only in the reception, viewing gallery and lounge, never at the chambers

- optional supplementary LED lighting for early clutches
- temperature and humidity monitoring in every chamber

- rings, microchips, CITES and pedigrees in one database
- live stream from the chambers for clients (as on falconsvalley.com)

05 · FLIGHT AVIARIES

Three sections, each over 2,300 m²

Free flight is what separates a top falcon from an average one. Each line has its own section with a 55 – 70 m flight line so that young falcons build muscle, stamina and confidence in the air before hacking, sale and training.



Flight aviary concept. Black knotless netting on slim galvanised masts, grass floor, rock and timber perches, the lounge pavilion in the background.

Section A · pure Gyr

≈ 2 440 m² · east, by the tree line

- the coolest and shadiest part of the plot
- more rock perches and flat gravel – gyrs like to sit low
- large shallow bath 3 × 3 m, 15 cm deep
- 4 × 6 m shelter on the north side

Section B · Golden Saker

≈ 2 430 m² · south, the sunniest

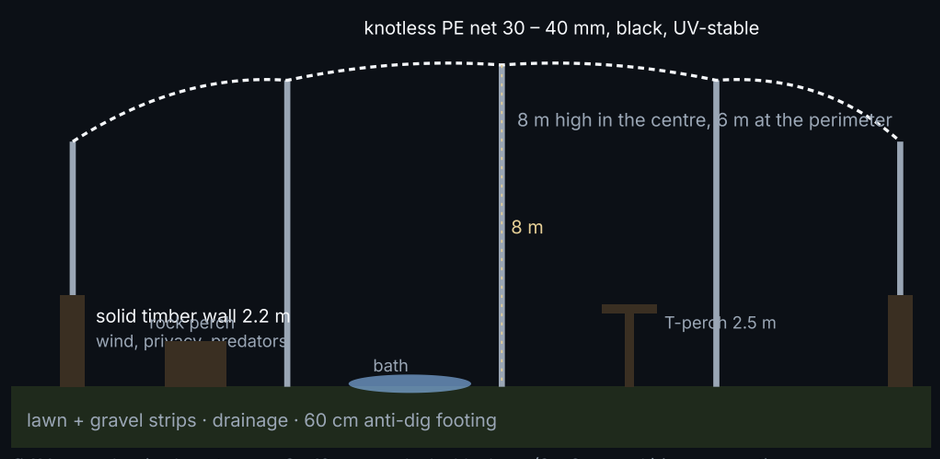
- open, sunny “steppe” character
- raised perches 2 – 3 m and earth mounds
- shade pergola and bath near the lounge
- the longest flight axis ≈ 70 m

Section C · Gyr × Shaheen

≈ 2 420 m² · west, by the hall yard

- the shortest route from the chambers in the hall
- open meadow once house 439 is demolished
- tall perches for the fast hybrids
- service gate from the hall yard (deliveries, machinery)

Flight aviary cross-section (schematic)



Ø 114 mm galvanised masts every 8 – 10 m, guyed · double doors (2 × 2 m porch) in every section

Aviary technical specification

- **Net:** knotless polyethylene, 30 – 40 mm mesh, black, UV-stabilised, soft – it gives on impact
- **Height:** 8 m on the central masts, 6 m at the perimeter; the net hangs on steel cables and is not pulled drum-tight
- **Perimeter:** solid 2.2 m timber slat wall (no see-through, no draught) + 60 cm concrete footing against foxes and martens; net above the wall
- **Between sections:** double net wall with a 1 m gap
- **Entrances:** 2 × 2 m porch with double doors in every section; service gate from the hall yard into section C
- **Equipment:** 6 – 10 perches of different heights, rock blocks, bath with inlet and drain, 4 × 6 m shelter, lawn irrigation, cameras

- **Maintenance:** mowing, weekly net inspection, clearing snow from the nets in winter (hence cables with a fall)

06 · CENTRAL LOUNGE · MAJLIS

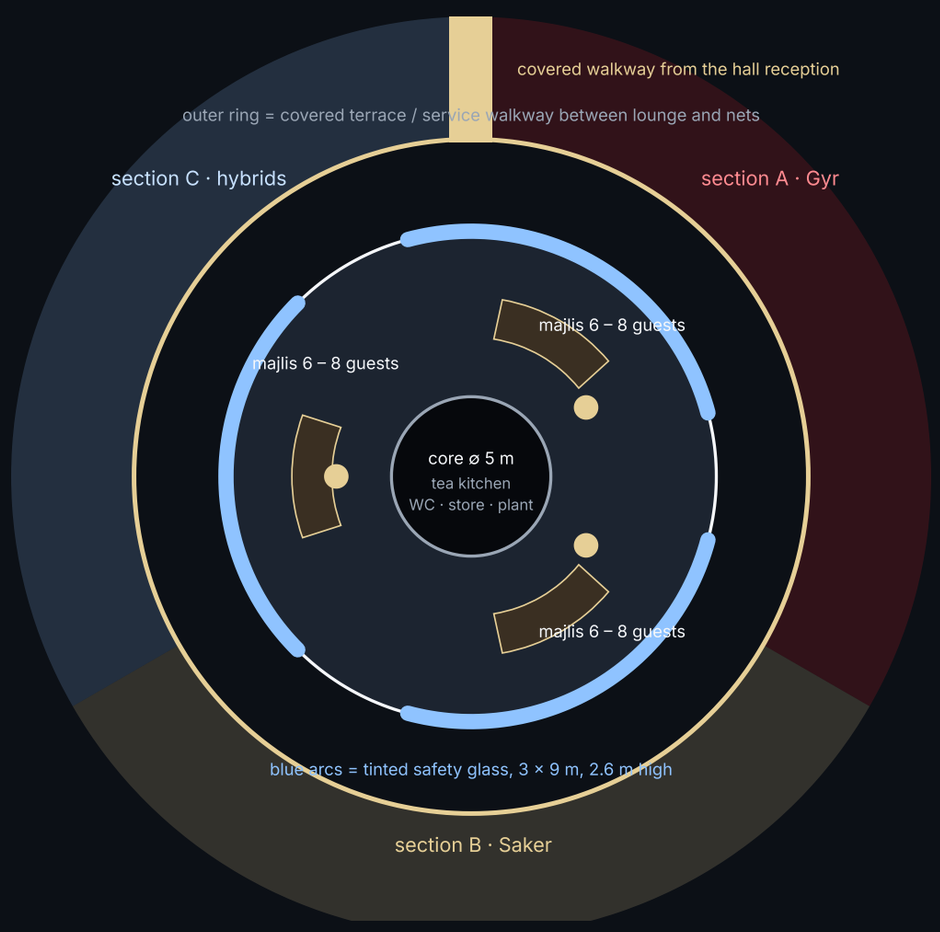
Tea, quiet and falcons behind the glass

The circular pavilion in the centre of the plot is where clients from the Gulf are received the way they are used to: low seating, a dallah of coffee, tea, dates – and behind tinted glass the three flight aviaries with gyrs, sakers and hybrids. From inside the aviaries the glass is dark and marked so the falcons do not strike it.

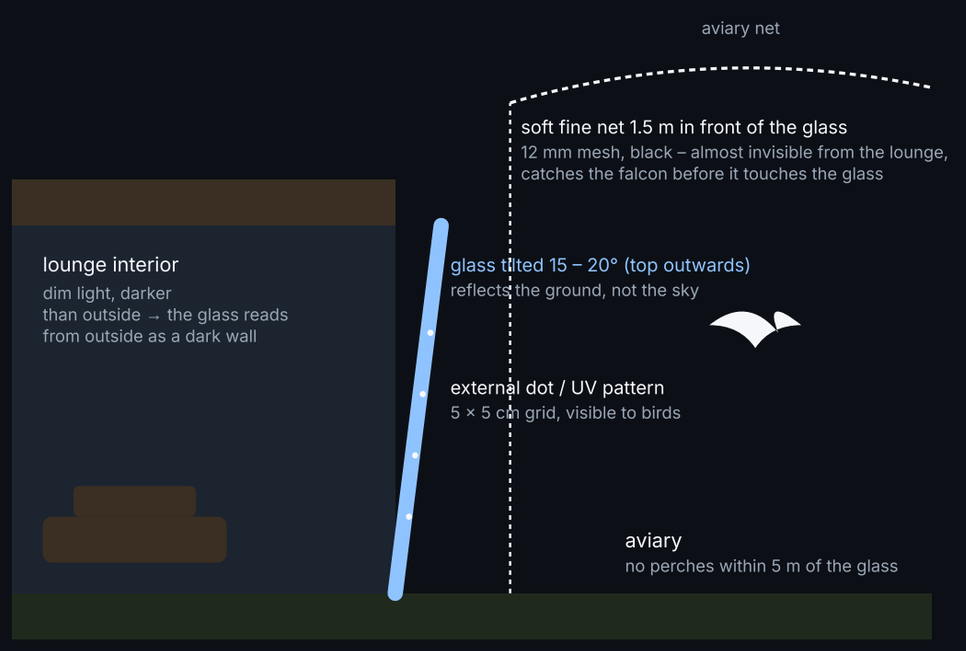


Lounge interior concept. Arabic majlis with low seating, timber ceiling, glazing into the aviary with falcons in flight.

Lounge floor plan (⌀ 22 m incl. terrace)



Glass section: how the falcon “sees” it



Glass: laminated safety 66.2 (2 × 6 mm + interlayer), tinted to 15 – 20 % transmission, low external reflectance. Automatic blinds at dusk – no light from the lounge into the aviary at night.
Result: from the lounge you see the falcons in full light; the falcon sees a dark, marked wall with a soft net in front o

The three-layer combination (tilt + pattern + net) is safer than tinting alone.

Lounge programme

- 3 seating bays (majlis) for 6 – 8 guests, each looking into a different section
- central core: tea kitchen (gahwa, tea, dates), WC, store, plant
- fire pit / fireplace in the centre or on the terrace for cool evenings

Materials and atmosphere

- glulam radial beams, timber ceiling, stone floor with underfloor heating
- colours: dark timber, cream and deep red fabric (Falcons Valley colours), brass
- dim indirect light, acoustically quiet space

Operation

- guests enter only via the hall reception and the covered walkway – never through the aviaries
- feeding the falcons in front of the glass at set times = a “show” for clients
- the lounge is where contracts are signed and the falcon and its CITES

- screens streaming the breeding chambers – the client also sees the falcon's parents

- covered terrace around the perimeter – access to the nets and servicing

papers handed over

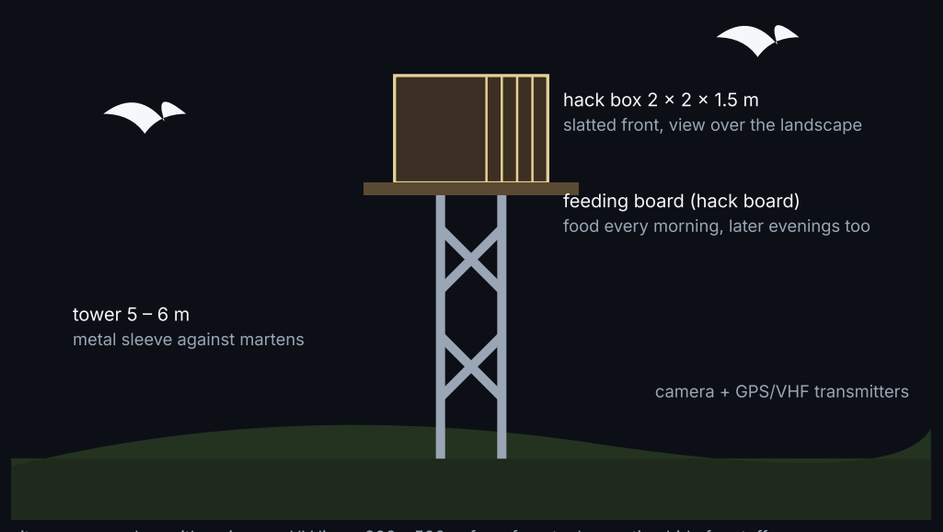
- step-free, heated, usable all year round

07 · WILD HACKING

Fledglings 2 – 4 weeks in the wild

Hacking is an old falconry method: shortly before their first flight the young are placed in a hack box on a raised site; after a few days the box is opened and the young falcons fly free but return every day to the feeding board. Two to four weeks of free flight over the meadows and crags of the Pieniny give them what no aviary can: strength, orientation, aerial play with their siblings and first hunting attempts. They are then recaptured and returned to the centre for training.

Hack tower (schematic)



site: open meadow with a view, no HV lines, 300 – 500 m from forest, observation hide for staff

How it works

- **Age 32 – 38 days:** the young (3 – 5 siblings at a time) are fitted with transmitters and moved to the hack box; they are fed there for 5 – 7 days and learn the landscape
- **Release:** in the morning in good weather; the first days they fly briefly and sit near the box
- **2 – 4 weeks:** food stays on the board (quail, chicks); the young range further, play, chase each other and try attacks on prey
- **Recapture:** when they stop coming to the board regularly or make a first kill – bow trap on the board or lure recall
- **Supervision:** 2 people, daily telemetry monitoring, camera on the tower, weight and flight records

The hacking site – photos from the field



Open country below the Tatras. Wide fields without tall forest or high-voltage lines – exactly the terrain a hack tower needs: the young have a clear view and staff can watch them from afar.

Foto: Falcons Valley



Rolling fields and copses of Zamagurie. Undulating ground with small woods gives the young falcons natural landmarks and thermals; in summer voles and larks are hunted here.

Foto: Falcons Valley

April
hatching in the hall

May
parent-rearing, ringing, microchipping

June
move to the hack box, release

June – July
2 – 4 weeks of free flight, recapture

July – August
flight aviaries, manning, preparation for sale

from August
handover to clients, lounge, CITES

Why hack

- better condition and muscle than from an aviary – key for racing and houbara hawking
- natural orientation, pitch and confidence in flight
- fewer stereotypies and less stress in later training
- a strong sales argument: “hacked in the Pieniny”

Site and equipment

- hack tower on the meadows by the Dunajec or on the slope above the town (agreement with the landowner)
- 2 hack boxes for 3 – 5 young each, feeding board, bow trap
- GPS/VHF transmitters (backpack or tail-mount), receiver, 4G camera
- 4×4 vehicle, transport boxes, food store at the tower

Risks and permits

- predators (eagle owl, goshawk, marten) – telemetry, metal tower sleeve, recapture on weight loss
- power lines and roads – site without HV lines, away from the main road
- temporary release of captive-bred birds must be agreed in advance with the PIENAP administration and the district authority (nature protection, CITES); every bird carries a ring, chip and transmitter
- weather: release only in a stable spell, never in rain

08 · BREEDING LINES

Gyr pure · Golden Saker · Gyr × Shaheen



White gyrfalcon (Falco rusticolus) – black spotting on the wings, powerful build.

Foto: Falcons Valley



This year’s youngster on the gravel of the breeding chamber.

Foto: Falcons Valley



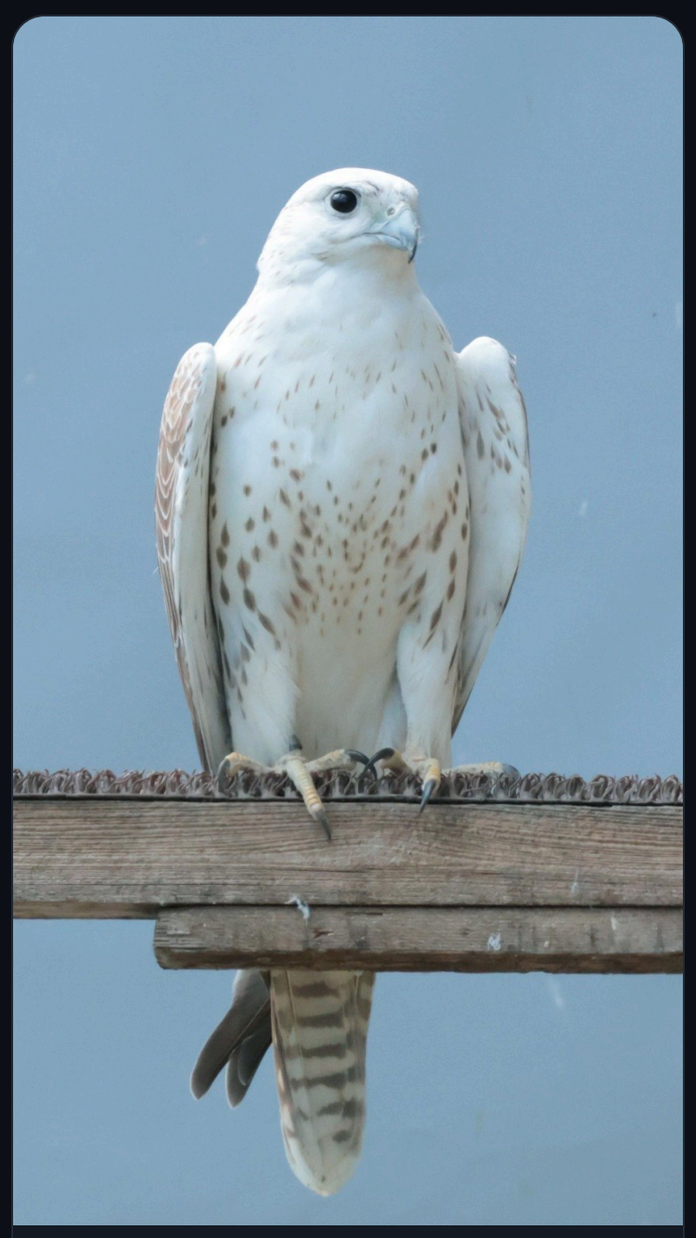
Pale birds of the golden line on the perch – pairs are matched in the chambers by colour and temperament.

Foto: Falcons Valley



One season, one perch: fledged youngsters before moving to the flight aviary.

Foto: Falcons Valley



White female with fine spotting – the type most sought after by Gulf clients.

Foto: Falcons Valley



Golden bird with wings spread – pale flight feathers with a dark trailing edge.

Foto: Falcons Valley



Pure white gyr in the breeding chamber – the foundation of the Falcons Valley white line.

Foto: Falcons Valley



Young falcon with a streaked breast and closed ring – every bird is ringed and microchipped.

Foto: Falcons Valley

Photographs of our breeding birds and young – gyrs, golden sakers and hybrids on which the breeding in Spišská Stará Ves will be founded.

Gyr pure

Falco rusticolus · white and silver morphs

- the largest falcon in the world, females 1,300 – 2,000 g
- needs cool, dry, clean air – north side of the hall, section A in the shade of the trees
- prone to aspergillosis: filtered ventilation, no mould, no dust
- late clutch (March – April), 3 – 5 eggs
- highest value for Gulf clients (white females)

Golden Saker

Falco cherrug · golden (pale) morph

- the traditional falcon of Arab falconry (“hurr”)
- hardy, undemanding, tolerates sun and heat – section B in the south
- early clutch (February – March), 3 – 5 eggs
- excellent for houbara hawking, prized for colour and size
- the basis for gyr hybrids

Gyr × Shaheen

F. rusticolus × *F. peregrinus* (peregrinator / babylonicus)

- the power and size of the gyr, the speed and agility of the shaheen
- more heat-tolerant than a pure gyr – section C
- produced by artificial insemination or imprint pairs – imprint chambers on the ground floor
- the most sought-after hybrid for racing (Fazza, King Abdulaziz Falconry Festival)
- different ratios 3/4 gyr, 1/2 gyr to the client’s wish

Capacity: 40 breeding chambers upstairs + 8 downstairs allow 60 – 100 young per year from 25 – 30 occupied pairs. Every chick receives a closed ring, microchip, CITES certificate and pedigree – the same standard as in the shop on falconsvalley.com.

09 · NEXT STEPS

From study to the first clutch

01

Survey and design

Land survey, structural assessment of the hall, demolition permit for house 439, architectural study and planning / building permit documentation.

02

Breeding permits

Breeding and CITES registration (Ministry of Environment, State Nature Conservancy), veterinary approval, registration of breeding stock, quarantine regime, hacking agreement with the PIENAP administration.

03

Hall conversion

Ground floor: reception, hatchery, rearing, vet, food kitchen, freezers. Upper floor: 40 skylit breeding chambers, service corridor, cameras.

04

Aviaries and lounge

Demolition of house 439, footings and masts, timber perimeter walls, nets, perches and baths; circular lounge pavilion, tinted glass, covered walkway from the hall.

05

Stocking

Move the breeding pairs in before the season (October – December) so they settle in the

06

First season

Rearing, hacking in June – July, flight aviaries, first client visits to the lounge in July – September, sales from August.

chambers before laying in February – April.

Important: the site plan is drawn indicatively from the cadastral map and Google satellite imagery (deviation up to ± 3 m). The interior and exterior visualisations are AI concept renders to convey the atmosphere, not design documentation. Section areas will be refined after the land survey; all three sections have a margin above the required minimum of 2,000 m².

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